



Death of a general

Missouri's Nathaniel Lyon was a bold and aggressive political leader, and he conducted his final battle, at Wilson's Creek in August 1861, in the same manner. He was the first Union general to be killed in combat.

“This means war ... One of my officers will call for you and conduct you out of my lines.”

CAPTAIN LYON TO GOVERNOR JACKSON, JUNE 12, 1861

The Kentucky divide

Kentucky was in many ways the quintessential border state. Birthplace of both Lincoln and Davis, its northern border on the Ohio River had always been a symbolic and powerful dividing line between the Free-Soil North and the slave-holding South. In Harriet Beecher Stowe's famous *Uncle Tom's Cabin*, one character makes a daring escape to freedom with her son across the Ohio River in order to save him from an unscrupulous slave-trader. Unionist sympathies were qualified, however. Only 1,364 Kentuckians voted